ROOT CAUSE ANALYSIS — COURSE ASSESSMENT

10 Multiple Choice Questions & Answer Key

1. What is the main objective of conducting a Root Cause Analysis (RCA)?

A) Assigning blame to individuals

B) Identifying underlying causes to prevent recurrence

C) Fixing symptoms as quickly as possible

D) Documenting financial losses

Answer: B) Identifying underlying causes to prevent recurrence

2. Which problem-solving technique repeatedly asks a core question to drill down to the fundamental cause?

A) 5 Whys

B) 5S Framework

C) Brainstorming 360

D) Gantt Analysis

Answer: A) 5 Whys

3. What is another common name for the Fishbone Diagram used in Root Cause Analysis?

A) Pareto Chart

B) Ishikawa Diagram

C) Control Chart

D) Scatter Diagram

Answer: B) Ishikawa Diagram

4. In a Fishbone Diagram, what is represented at the "head" of the fish?

A) Root cause

B) Proposed solution

C) Problem statement (effect)

D) Team leader's name

Answer: C) Problem statement (effect)

5. What is a symptom in contrast to a root cause?

A) The fundamental systemic failure

B) An observable sign or outcome of a problem

C) The final corrective action plan

D) An unintended positive result

Answer: B) An observable sign or outcome of a problem

6. What does FTA stand for in advanced root cause investigation methodologies?

A) Fast Task Assignment

B) Fault Tree Analysis

C) Final Failure Tracking

D) First Time Audit

Answer: B) Fault Tree Analysis

7. Which category is typically included in the 6Ms framework for manufacturing RCA?

A) Manpower / Mindset

B) Money

C) Marketing

D) Milestones

Answer: A) Manpower / Mindset

8. What is the difference between a Corrective Action and a Preventive Action?

A) Corrective eliminates identified causes; Preventive eliminates potential causes

B) Preventive is done after an incident; Corrective is done before

C) Corrective applies only to machines; Preventive applies to people

D) There is no functional difference between them

Answer: A) Corrective eliminates identified causes; Preventive eliminates potential causes

9. What visual quality tool helps prioritize causes based on the 80/20 rule?

A) Histogram
B) Flowchart
C) Pareto Chart
D) Check Sheet

Answer: C) Pareto Chart

10. What step should follow immediately after identifying the root cause of an issue?

A) Close the project file
B) Develop and implement corrective action plans
C) Conduct employee performance reviews
D) Restart the 5 Whys process

Answer: B) Develop and implement corrective action plans